

Elon Musk • Verifiable trajectory

Public records only • Tier A/B sources • Motives & judgments excluded

core milestones (P0)
1971 → 2026
Verified 2026-08-04



Formative 1971–1994 Access to larger markets	Internet capital 1995–2002 Capital formation	Dual bet 2002–2012 Parallel hard-tech bets	Scale 2013–2020 Reuse & volume	Platform & politics 2021–2025 Distribution & power	Present 2025–2026 IPO & present
1971-06● Born in Pretoria, South Africa 1988● Emigrates to Canada 1989● Studies at Queen’s University 1992● Transfers to University of Pennsylvania 1983● Sells Blastar game at age 12	1995● Leaves Stanford PhD after two days 1995● Co-founds Zip2 1997● UPenn bachelor’s degrees 1999● Compaq acquires Zip2 (~\$307M) 1999● Founds X.com 2000● X.com merges with Confinity → PayPal 2002● eBay acquires PayPal (\$1.5B) 2002● Becomes a U.S. citizen	2002-05● Founds SpaceX 2004-02● Leads Tesla Series A; board chair 2008-09● Falcon 1 reaches orbit 2008-10● Becomes Tesla CEO 2010-06● Falcon 9 first orbital flight 2010● Tesla IPO 2012● Model S launches 2012-05● Dragon visits the ISS	2015● Co-founds OpenAI 2015-12● Falcon 9 first-stage land landing 2016● Founds Neuralink 2017● Model 3 deliveries begin 2018-02● Falcon Heavy first flight 2018● SEC suit & settlement (“funding secured”) 2020-05● Crew Dragon flies NASA astronauts to ISS	2022● Completes Twitter acquisition (\$44B) 2023-07● Twitter rebranded to X 2023● Founds xAI • Grok 2024-11● Named to lead DOGE 2025-01● Executive order establishes DOGE structure 2025-05● Ends DOGE role	2026-06● SpaceX IPO 2025-11● Tesla shareholders approve mega pay package